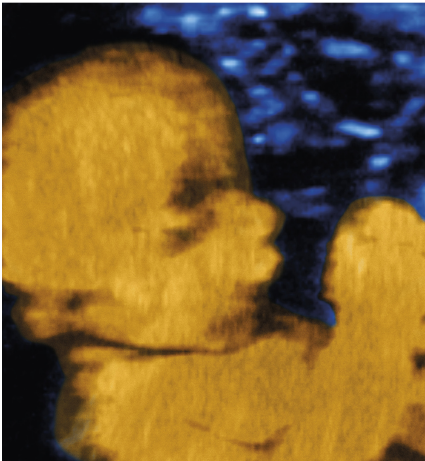




YOU ARE **33 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
48 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby may well be head down by this stage. The head is the heaviest part and gravity plus the shape of your uterus favors a head-down position. Ask your doctor at the next visit whether they can determine the position for you.

“Premature labor is highly likely in a twin pregnancy, so your doctor will be on alert and monitoring you closely.”

If you're expecting twins they may arrive any time now. Most singleton pregnancies are 38 to 42 weeks, but if you're carrying twins, 37 to 39 weeks is optimal. But over half of twins are born before 37 weeks. Women expecting twins are at higher risk of high blood pressure, preeclampsia, placental insufficiency, gestational diabetes, and may need to be induced early. That said, many women do go on to deliver twins vaginally.

Depending on the type of twins you are having, your doctor may recommend delivering as early as 32 weeks, or up to 39 weeks, as well as anytime in between.

If the babies are in any position other than “head down,” or the placenta is in an awkward position, such as near the neck of the uterus, a Cesarean may be recommended. Some doctors prefer to deliver twins by Cesarean because the second twin may run into difficulties during the delivery, particularly if they are not head down.

Premature babies are more at risk of complications than those who go to full-term. A Cesarean ensures the babies are delivered quickly without having to go through hours of potentially stressful labor.

BIRTHWEIGHT OF TWINS

The average birth weight of twins is 5 lb 8 oz (2.5 kg). This is compared to 7 lb 8 oz (3.5 kg) for singleton babies. It's not unusual for there to be a difference in birth weight between the babies. In fact, one twin may weigh 2 to 3 lb more than the other.

ASK A MIDWIFE

I'm having my twins in a couple of weeks. Can they sleep in the same crib? Having shared the same tight space in the uterus for many months, it seems natural to allow twin newborns to sleep together and, in fact, research indicates that it may have some benefits. Not only has it been found to be safe for twins of roughly the same size to sleep together until three months of age,